

STRAWBERRY DREAM ROMPER

SIZES 44 TO 92

A sleeveless romper with a knitted-in leaf yoke, seeds, an integrated skirt and a buttoned opening at the crotch. Graded in nine sizes, from small newborn up to two years.

44

small newborn / preemie

50

newborn, 0-1 mo

56

1-2 mo

62

2-4 mo

68

4-6 mo

74

6-9 mo

80

9-12 mo

86

12-18 mo

92

18-24 mo, 2 years

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Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. **Test knit version 1.0**

BEFORE YOU START

The romper is knitted top-down. The yoke is first worked back and forth for a small opening at centre back, then joined in the round. The armhole stitches are set aside, the body is worked in the round down to the waist, and the skirt is worked out from there. Finally the skirt is folded up and the front and back are shaped into the nappy panel.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- knitting a round yoke from the top down
- working leaf and seed charts in two colours
- shaping armholes and a nappy panel
- making buttonholes and picking up edgings

DIFFICULTY

Easy to slightly experienced. The nappy panel is the only part worked back and forth, and there you decrease at each side on every right side row.

SIZES

The pattern is graded in nine sizes, from 44 to 92, that is from small newborn to two years. Choose by the child's chest measurement, not by age. The ages are only a guide, and a baby born early follows its own curve. Between two sizes, take the larger one, since a garment that is slightly big lasts longer.

THE CHILD'S MEASUREMENTS

Size	Suits	Child chest	Ease
44	small newborn / preemie	32 cm	6,1 cm
50	newborn, 0-1 mo	35 cm	6,9 cm
56	1-2 mo	38 cm	5,8 cm
62	2-4 mo	41 cm	6,6 cm
68	4-6 mo	43 cm	6,5 cm
74	6-9 mo	45 cm	6,4 cm
80	9-12 mo	47 cm	6,3 cm
86	12-18 mo	49 cm	6,2 cm
92	18-24 mo, 2 years	51 cm	6,1 cm

HOW TO READ THE TABLES

Every number in the pattern is given in its own column per size. Find your column once, mark it with a pen, and read only that one from there on.

FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

Size	Chest	Total length	Yoke depth	Skirt
44	38,1 cm	31 cm	10,0 cm	8 cm
50	41,9 cm	34 cm	11,4 cm	9 cm
56	43,8 cm	37 cm	12,1 cm	10 cm
62	47,6 cm	40 cm	12,9 cm	11 cm
68	49,5 cm	43 cm	13,6 cm	12 cm
74	51,4 cm	45 cm	13,9 cm	13 cm
80	53,3 cm	48 cm	14,6 cm	14 cm
86	55,2 cm	50 cm	15,0 cm	15 cm
92	57,1 cm	52 cm	15,4 cm	16 cm

The measurements below are the garment as it should be after washing and drying flat. If you get different measurements, it is usually the gauge and not the pattern.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	double-pointed or Magic Loop for neck, armholes and crotch
4 flat buttons	approx. 10-12 mm, 3 at the crotch and 1 at the neck
Darning needle	for weaving in ends and sewing down the picot edge
Stitch marker	to mark the beginning of the round and the waist

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
44	455 g	40 g	5 g
50	550 g	45 g	5 g
56	630 g	45 g	5 g
62	740 g	50 g	5 g
68	830 g	55 g	5 g
74	925 g	55 g	5 g
80	1025 g	55 g	5 g
86	1130 g	60 g	5 g
92	1240 g	60 g	5 g

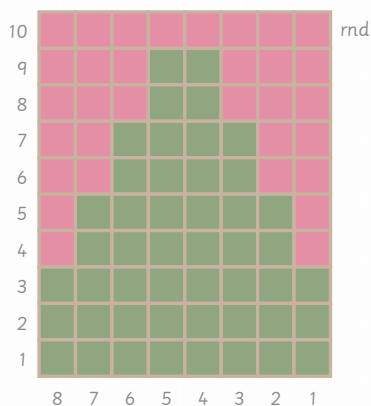
GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means one needle size up, fewer means one down. The gauge decides every measurement here.

LEAF AND SEED CHARTS

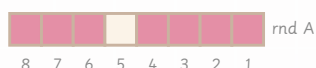
Both charts are read from the bottom up, and each round from right to left, the same way you knit. The leaf repeat is 8 stitches and is repeated all the way round the yoke. The number of repeats for your size is given further on.

LEAF, 8 STITCHES x 10 ROUNDS

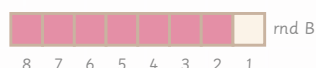


SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches scattered over the pink. Work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. Repeat as densely or as sparsely as you like.

The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.

1 • NECK AND OPENING

Cast on in green on 4 mm needles and work 4 rows of twisted rib back and forth, that is 1 twisted knit, 1 purl. On row 3 make one small buttonhole 3 stitches in from the edge: knit 2 together, yarn over. Continue in stocking stitch back and forth.

THE INCREASES

Divide the stitches into 8 equal sections and place a marker between each. Increase 1 stitch in each section every other row, that is 8 stitches per increase round. When the back opening measures approx. 4 cm, cast on 2 stitches over the opening and join to work in the round. Continue the increases in the round until you have the stitch count in your column.

Size	Cast on	Per section	Increase rounds	After increases	Even rnds after
44	56 sts	7	7	112 sts	3
50	64 sts	8	8	128 sts	5
56	64 sts	8	9	136 sts	5
62	72 sts	9	10	152 sts	5
68	72 sts	9	11	160 sts	5
74	80 sts	10	11	168 sts	6
80	80 sts	10	12	176 sts	6
86	80 sts	10	13	184 sts	5
92	88 sts	11	13	192 sts	6

When the increases are done, work the number of even rounds in the last column without increasing. They give the yoke the depth it needs.

2 • THE LEAF TIPS

Work the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches, and repeat it as many times as your column says. The first round sits at the top of the garment, but the chart is still read from the bottom up, because it is turned for top-down knitting. Finish with 1 round in pink.

Size	Stitches in yoke	Leaf repeats round	Yoke depth
44	112 sts	14 x	10,0 cm
50	128 sts	16 x	11,4 cm
56	136 sts	17 x	12,1 cm
62	152 sts	19 x	12,9 cm
68	160 sts	20 x	13,6 cm
74	168 sts	21 x	13,9 cm
80	176 sts	22 x	14,6 cm
86	184 sts	23 x	15,0 cm
92	192 sts	24 x	15,4 cm

Check the stitch count before dividing for the armholes. If the leaf repeat does not come out even, an increase has slipped in or been missed higher up.

3 • DIVIDE FOR ARMHOLES

Read the row for your size from left to right, in the order you knit: the front, the stitches you place on hold for the first armhole, the stitches you cast on under the arm, the back, then the same armhole on the other side.

Size	Front	Hold for armhole	Cast on	Back	Body
44	38	18	2	38	80 sts
50	42	22	2	42	88 sts
56	44	24	2	44	92 sts
62	48	28	2	48	100 sts
68	50	30	2	50	104 sts
74	52	32	2	52	108 sts
80	54	34	2	54	112 sts
86	56	36	2	56	116 sts
92	58	38	2	58	120 sts

THE BODY

Work in pink stocking stitch in the round. Scatter seeds: seed round A, 2-3 rounds in pink, then seed round B. Work until the body measures the length in the table on the next page, measured straight down from the underarm, and place a marker in the round. That marker is the waist.

4 • THE SKIRT

From the waist marker work *k2, M1*, repeat round. Continue in pink stocking stitch with scattered seeds until the skirt measures the length in the last column. Then work 3 rounds in pink, 1 eyelet round *yarn over, k2tog*, and 3 rounds in pink. Cast off loosely. Fold along the eyelet round to the wrong side and sew down into a soft picot edge.

Size	Body from underarm	Body stitches	*k2, M1* gives	Skirt width	Skirt length
44	10 cm	80 sts	120 sts	57,1 cm	8 cm
50	11 cm	88 sts	132 sts	62,9 cm	9 cm
56	12 cm	92 sts	138 sts	65,7 cm	10 cm
62	13 cm	100 sts	150 sts	71,4 cm	11 cm
68	14 cm	104 sts	156 sts	74,3 cm	12 cm
74	15 cm	108 sts	162 sts	77,1 cm	13 cm
80	16 cm	112 sts	168 sts	80,0 cm	14 cm
86	17 cm	116 sts	174 sts	82,9 cm	15 cm
92	18 cm	120 sts	180 sts	85,7 cm	16 cm

The skirt is deliberately short. It sits over the nappy panel, not under it, and a long skirt would get in the way at nappy changes.

5 • THE NAPPY PANEL

Fold the skirt up out of the way. Continue in the round on the body stitches from the waist marker and work pink stocking stitch for the length in your column. Then divide the work into two equal halves, front and back, and work each half separately back and forth. Decrease 1 stitch at each side on every right side row until the number in the last column remains.

Size	Body stitches	Length from waist	Split into two	Decrease to
44	80 sts	8 cm	2 x 40 sts	20 sts
50	88 sts	9 cm	2 x 44 sts	22 sts
56	92 sts	10 cm	2 x 46 sts	24 sts
62	100 sts	11 cm	2 x 50 sts	26 sts
68	104 sts	12 cm	2 x 52 sts	28 sts
74	108 sts	13 cm	2 x 54 sts	30 sts
80	112 sts	14 cm	2 x 56 sts	32 sts
86	116 sts	15 cm	2 x 58 sts	34 sts
92	120 sts	16 cm	2 x 60 sts	36 sts

Work the back 4 rows longer than the front. That puts the buttons underneath the baby rather than on top, and the crotch closes smoothly.

6 • BUTTON BANDS AND EDGINGS

THE CROTCH

Work 6 rows of twisted rib over the crotch stitches on both pieces. On row 3 of the front, make 3 buttonholes evenly spaced: yarn over, k2tog. Cast off in rib. Sew the 3 buttons onto the back, directly under the buttonholes.

ARMHOLES AND NECK

Pick up the stitches in your column round each armhole in green: the held sleeve stitches, the stitches you cast on under the arm, and 1 stitch in each of the two corners. Work 4 rounds of twisted rib and cast off with stretch. Finally sew the fourth button at the neck.

Size	Crotch stitches	Buttonholes	Pick up per armhole
44	20 sts	3	22 sts
50	22 sts	3	26 sts
56	24 sts	3	28 sts
62	26 sts	3	32 sts
68	28 sts	3	34 sts
74	30 sts	3	36 sts
80	32 sts	3	38 sts
86	34 sts	3	40 sts
92	36 sts	3	42 sts

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the romper is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Chest after washing

Total length after washing

Time taken, roughly

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Check that the crotch buttons do not press when the baby lies on its back.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on children's garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. In the smallest sizes the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless with a leaf yoke and a flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, with a nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper and skirt, a two-piece set with an elasticated waist.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a connecting cord, sizes 44 to 74.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with a folded rib cuff and ties at the ankle, sizes 44 to 92.

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